> society, labelled backward, uncivilised and degenerate, was all pervasive. Notice the words used by Ambedkar: '....some communities like the Hindu community needed the reform so badly- it was a slum clearance'.

This discussion based on scholarly literature is sufficient for the purview of this book to demonstrate the manifest hand of Christian European coloniality, 'the hand of G_d', so to speak, in the reshaping of Indic consciousness. What is important to note is the critical similarity and equally critical difference between Middle Eastern coloniality and European coloniality. While both believe in the concept of 'false religion' in the context of native societies which do not share their faith, the former destroys 'false religions' root and branch through overt subjugation, while the latter attempts to convert, failing which, it subtly moulds and reconstructs other faith systems in its own image by applying its framework to bring them in line with Christian consciousness. The former's direct and visible aggression invited fierce resistance from Indic consciousness, while the latter's attempt to Christianise it through its policy of toleration and secularism resulted in the integration of the native Indic consciousness in a Eurocentric 'modern' global order. This has made it much more difficult for Indic consciousness and its way of life to be understood on its own terms without suffering labels, such as 'ancient', 'traditional', 'conservative', and the like. Critically, De Roover points out that this model of Christian reconstruction of indigenous faith systems and societies has been secularised, and goes by the name of 'secularism', wherein the colonial framework with its distinct religious/scriptural origin is projected as 'universal' for all societies and cultures.

I will elaborate on the British coloniser's movement from the policy of toleration to adoption of secularism in the next section where I address the period between 1858 and 1919, but first, the impact of the coloniser's Christian reconstructionism on native OET needs to be understood.

Every society's subjective experience leads to the formation of its own views on ontology, which ultimately forms the basis of its epistemology and theology, including its social organisation. In this regard, broadly speaking, the ontology of Indic consciousness rests, among other things, on the belief in the laws of *karma* and rebirth which manifest in its knowledge production structures, its faith systems, its relationship with nature and its